

Playtesting Plan

The goal is to assess the player's first complete interaction cycle inside the initial room, including discovery of the environment, use of the E key to interact with clues, and emotional engagement with the scene.

We want to identify any points where the player feels confused, detached, or unsure about what to do, and test whether the room effectively introduces the game's tone and mechanics.

Focus Areas:

- Control Discovery: Do players learn how to move and interact naturally?
- Clue Visibility: Is the first clue visually noticeable and inviting?
- Interaction Feedback: Does pressing E feel responsive and meaningful?
- Emotional Tone: Does the room evoke curiosity, sadness, or nostalgia?
- Flow & Timing: Do players know what to do next, and is the pacing smooth?
- Environmental Clarity: Do lighting, sound, and visuals guide attention effectively?
- Player Understanding: Do players connect the clue to the story or memory theme?

Playtesting Questions:

1. How easily did you understand what you were supposed to do in the first room?
2. When you reached the clue, how did you realize you could press E to interact?
3. After pressing E, did you clearly understand what changed or happened in the scene?
4. How did the moment of interacting with the clue make you feel?
5. What would make this interaction (or the whole room) more engaging or clear?

Playtesting Insights

Feedback:

- ☐ backing out with clues
- ☐ clicking (seeing a mouse)
- ☐ the goal of the room isn't very clear
- ☐ info retention (are clues important)
- ☐ intro what is going (context (day, where))
- ☐ space to exit the clue
- ☐ no clue on why you're reading the clues
- ☐ not easy to read the clues
- ☐ clue exit
- ☐ objective isn't clear
- ☐ They want to click out of the clues
- ☐ September and October on calendar
- ☐ try to go to the game via coming close to button
- ☐ not an escape room
- ☐ clues are very obvious, adding non-interactive clues
- ☐ no coming back to the scenes
- ☐ no button if person decides to go back to clue
- ☐ sound effect
- ☐ wind music box with interact
- ☐ "213 clues found"
- ☐ block exit instead of the button to move to the game

Playtesting Implementations

- Made clues less obvious by removing glowing effect around them
- Added clue counter to track number of clues found
- Created door to move to next room instead of button
- Included a short description at the beginning of the backstory to help player understand the goal
- Switched mismatched dates on clues